Jewish academics like Judith Butler, Noam Chomsky, Norman Finkelstein, and Richard Falk. Without Iran's financial and military backing, it is evident that neight Hezbollah nor Hamas would have acquired the weaponry which has turned them into dangerous adversaries of Israel and its neighbors. The growing American retreat from the Middle East has further exacerbated the danger, creaging a vacuum which has been filled, not only by Iranian proxies, but by the fnatic Sunni warriors of the Islamic State (ISIS).

The antisemitic fallout from the 2014 Gaza war has yet again underlined the impact of Islamist rage in the 21st century, and the myopia of the West regarding the threat which it represents. Yet, in the biased coverage of Hamas's endless provocations of Israel, mainstream Western media studiously ignore its fundamentalist ideology, its anti-Westernism and undisguised antisemitism. Similarly, little attention is paid to the centrality of martyrdom (*shahada*) and the cult of death at the heard of Hamas's world-view, which helps to explain its deliberate encouragement of the high toll of civilian deaths among its own people. Hamas was able to exploit the rising Palestinian body-count to denounce Israeli bombing of Gaza as a Zionist "mass extermination" on Nazi lines. This utterly mendacious claim echoed loudly in internet comments and social media throughout the Western world, as well as in parts of the mainstream media.

In the light of such demonization one can better understand why the Palestinian demonstrations in Europe during the summer of 2014 so swiftly spilled over into crude antisemitism. Much of this agitation was driven by young Muslims living in the European Union (EU)—especially in France, Holland, Belgium, Spain, Italy, Britain, and Germany. Their increased identification with Islam has been a factor along with the growing sense of alienation from Western society—whether they be Arabs from North Africa and the Middle East, Turks, West African Muslims, or South Asians in Britain.

Research has shown that antisemitic stereotypes are generally far more prevalent among Muslims in Europe than in most white populations. For example, close to half of British Muslims in December 2005 felt that "Jews are in league with the Freemasons to control the media and politics." Such a belief is rare among most Britons. In Denmark, in 2009, 66% of Muslim immigrants interviewed displayed markedly anti-Jewish attitudes. Studies in Belgium from 2011 showed that 45–50 percent of Muslim students agreed with antisemitic sentiments like "Jews want to dominate everything," as against only 10 percent of non-Muslims.[8] This is a general pattern in the EU and it is aggravated by a preexisting Manichean view of the Middle East conflict among many Muslims in Europe. The anti-Jewish stereotypes most often come from the home, the mosque, the internet, satellite TV, and the

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